

Yunfei Luo

Ph.D. Student in the Halicioğlu Data Science Institute at the University of California San Diego

☎ (413) 404 2124 @ yul268@ucsd.edu 📍 San Diego, CA
🔗 yunfeiluo.github.io in linkedin.com/in/yunfei-luo 🐙 github.com/yunfeiluo

Research Interests

- General** AI/ML, Digital Health, Signal Processing, Multimodal Learning, Multitask Learning, Foundation Model, Reinforcement Learning
- Specific** Yunfei's research focuses on machine learning in the field of digital health, signal processing, multimodal modeling, and multitask learning. He aims to develop a robust and well-generalized methodology that enhances intelligent monitoring, supports timely interventions, and is deployable on edge devices.
- Applications** Mental Health, Substance Usage, Kidney Dialysis, Digital Health Monitoring

Education

- 09.2023 - present **Ph.D. Student in the Halicioğlu Data Science Institute**
University of California, San Diego, CA
➤ Advisor : 📧 Tauhidur Rahman
➤ Research : Machine Learning, Multimodal Learning, Multitask Learning, Digital Health
- 09.2021 - 05.2023 **Master of Science in Computer and Information Science**
University of Massachusetts Amherst, Amherst, MA
➤ Advisor : Ina Fiterau Brostean | 📧 Information Fusion Lab
➤ Courses Taken : Advanced Machine Learning, Neural Networks, Probabilistic Graphical Models, Reinforcement Learning, Advanced Natural Language Processing, Advanced IoT
- 09.2017 - 05.2021 **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | Bachelor of Science in Mathematics** (Dual Degrees)
University of Massachusetts Amherst, Amherst, MA
➤ Machine Learning and Computing Specializations

Fellowships, Scholarships, Awards, and Honors

- 2023 - 2024 • Institute Fellowship | Halicioğlu Data Science Institute, UC San Diego
- 2021 - 2023 • Bay State Fellowship | Full Tuition Scholarship, UMass Amherst CICS
- 2017 - 2021 • Outstanding Undergrad Course Assistant Award, UMass Amherst CICS
• Chancellor's Award, UMass Amherst

Teaching Experience

- 09.2021 to 06.2023** **Graduate Teaching Assistant, CICS, UMass Amherst**
➤ CS 311 Introduction to Algorithm in Fall 2021 and Spring 2023
➤ CS 590OP Applied Numerical Optimization, and CS 108 Foundation of Data Science in Fall 2022
➤ CS 220 Programming Methodology in Spring 2022
➤ Held office hours, led weekly discussion sessions, graded course works, answered questions on course forum, attended weekly TA meeting for discussing the progress/improvements of the course
Javascript Algorithms Numerical Optimization Data Science Teaching
- 01.2020 to 06.2021** **Undergraduate Course Assistant, CICS, UMass Amherst**
➤ CS 240 Reasoning under Uncertainty in Spring 2021, CS 311 Introduction to Algorithms in Fall 2020, CS 220 Programming Methodology in Spring 2020
➤ Helped with weekly discussion session, graded course works, and answered questions on Piazza
Javascript Algorithms Probability Teaching

Work Experience

07.2023 05.2026	Graduate Student Researcher, AI/ML, University of California San Diego ➤ Research focus on machine learning in signal processing and digital healthcare. Detailed works are presented in the <i>Publications</i> section Research and DevelopmentMachine LearningDigital HealthcareSignal ProcessingNatural Language Processing
06.2022 to 06.2023	Graduate Research Assistant, DS4CG Intern, Machine Learning Engineering, Center for Data Science, University of Massachusetts Amherst ➤ Developed platform for Building Segmentation and Damage Assessment based on Satellite Imagery ➤ Integrated the Machine Learning pipeline along with User Interface for Imagery Fetching and Labeling ➤ Conducted Research and Experiments with various Finetuning setting and Machine Learning techniques to support selections of final-deployed hyper-parameters and models ➤ Delivered a presentation of the project to the Red Cross (funder and client), resulting in exceptional satisfaction and securing an additional year of funding for the initiative ➤ Worked as Graduate Research Assistant after summer internship Computer VisionMachine LearningDisaster ResponseSoftware DevelopmentFull-Stack Development
06.2020 to 06.2021	Undergraduate Research Assistant, Core Summer Intern, Data Engineering, Institute for Applied Life Sciences, University of Massachusetts Amherst ➤ Built pipelines for fMRI data preprocessing and statistical analysis ➤ Conducted Research and Experiments with Machine Learning models for Stroke Detection : Autoencoders, CNNs, and GANs ➤ Worked as Undergraduate Research Assistant after summer internship Machine LearningfMRIData Preparation

Publications

2026 Published	Toward Foundation Model for Multivariate Wearable Sensing of Physiological Signals, ACM Computing for Healthcare (ACM HEALTH), Journal Yunfei Luo, Yuliang Chen, Asif Salekin, Tauhidur Rahman Signal ProcessingFoundation ModelNatural Language ProcessingMachine LearningNeural NetworksDigital Health
2026 Published	Personalized entropy-informed deep learning for identifying opioid misuse, Nature Mental Health, Journal Yunfei Luo, Iman Deznabi, Bhanu Gullapalli, Mark Tuomenoksa, Eric Garland, Madalina Fiterau, Tauhidur Rahman Signal ProcessingNatural Language ProcessingHeart Rate VariabilityAffective StatesOpioidClinical TreatmentMachine LearningMultimodal FusionDigital Health
2026 Published	Automated Dysphagia Screening Using Noninvasive Neck Acoustic Sensing, IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech, and Signal Processing (ICASSP), Conference Jade Chng, Rong Xing (Co-1st Author), Yunfei Luo (Co-1st Author), Kristen Linnemeyer-Risser, Tauhidur Rahman, Andrew Yousef, Philip A Weissbrod Signal ProcessingAcoustic SignalData CollectionClinical TreatmentApplied Machine LearningDigital Health
2025 Published	Sounding out Dysphagia : Using a Digital Stethoscope to Assess Audiometric Differences in Swallowing, The Laryngoscope, Journal Andrew Yousef, Sacha Moufarrej, David Zeng, Bao Luu, Rong Xing, James S. Crook, Yunfei Luo, Kristen Linnemeyer-Risser, Tauhidur Rahman, Philip A Weissbrod Signal ProcessingDigital HealthDysphagiaAcousticsNon-invasive
2025 Published	Opioid Misuse Detection from Cognitive and Physiological Data with Temporal Fusion Deep Learning, Drug and Alcohol Dependence, Journal Bhanu Gullapalli, Yunfei Luo, Tauhidur Rahman, Eric L. Garland Signal ProcessingMachine LearningDigital HealthAddictionPsychophysiologyChronic Pain

2024 Published	Dynamic Clustering via Branched Deep Learning Enhances Personalization of Stress Prediction from Mobile Sensor Data, <i>Nature Scientific Report, Journal</i> Yunfei Luo, Iman Deznabi, Abhinav Shaw, Tauhidur Rahman, Madalina Fiterau Brostean Multi-modal Fusion Methods Mental Health Machine Learning Neural Networks Time Series
2024 Published	Start Simple : Progressive Difficulty Multitask Learning, The Nations of the Americas Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (NAACL) 2024 SRW Proceedings, Conference Yunfei Luo, Yuyang Liu, Rukai Cai, Tauhidur Rahman Natural Language Processing Multi-task Learning Machine Learning Neural Networks
2023 Published	Agent Performing Autonomous Stock Trading under Good and Bad Situations, AI for Agent-Based Modelling (AI4ABM) in International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2023, Workshop Yunfei Luo, Zhangqi Duan Reinforcement Learning Machine Learning Neural Networks

Voluntary Professional Activities

Side Projects

- **Early-stage Startup Initiative : Co-Founder of ONTO** (integrated into Simplicity AI in March 2024), March 2023 to February 2024
 - > Designed a customizable virtual AI character framework with memory management, contextual awareness, prompt optimization, tone/style transformation, and jail-break defense mechanisms.
 - > Implemented a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) framework to improve AI character fidelity.
 - > Evaluated and strengthened framework robustness against jail-break attacks through iterative testing and vulnerability analysis.
 - > Collaborated with team members to track progress and plan future development.

Talks

- “Toward Foundation Model for Multivariate Wearable Sensing of Physiological Signals”, Lightning Talk at **Conference of Naval Applications of Machine Learning (NAML)**, March 3rd 2026
- “Foundation Model for Multivariate Wearable Sensing of Physiological Signals”, **Google Research Journal Club**, May 27th 2025
- “Health AI, foundation models, agents, and related research”, **Dexcom Journal Club**, April 18th 2023

Reviewer

- Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS), 2026
 - > Main Track 2026
- International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2026
 - > Main Track 2026
 - > Workshop on Time Series in the Age of Large Models, International Conference on Learning Representations (TSALM), 2026
 - > Workshop on AI with Recursive Self-Improvement (RSI), 2026
- International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML), 2025 to 2026
 - > Main Track 2026
 - > Workshop on Foundation Models for Structured Data, International Conference on Machine Learning (FMSD), 2025 to 2026
- Conference on Computational Natural Language Learning (CoNLL), 2024 to 2026
- Proceedings of ACM on Interactive, Mobile, Wearable and Ubiquitous Technologies (IMWUT), 2024 to 2026

Professional Certifications

2022	IBM Artificial Intelligence Engineering Professional Certificate
2022	Neuroscience and Neuroimaging Specialization Certificate
2020-2023	TensorFlow Developer Professional Certificate

References

Tauhidur Rahman

Assistant Professor of Data Science
University of California San Diego
Director of MOSAIC Lab
@ trahman@ucsd.edu

Benjamin Smarr

Associate Professor of Data Science
University of California San Diego
Department of Bioengineering
@ bsmarr@ucsd.edu

Tom Bernardin

Data Scientist
University of Massachusetts Amherst
Director of the Center for Data Science
@ tbernard@cs.umass.edu

Rakesh Malhotra

Assistant Professor of Medicine
University of California San Diego
Division of Nephrology-Hypertension
@ r3malhotra@health.ucsd.edu

Madalina Fiterau Brostean

Assistant Professor of Computer Science
University of Massachusetts Amherst
Lead of the Information Fusion Lab
@ mfiterau@cs.umass.edu

Daniel Sheldon

Associate Professor of Computer Science
University of Massachusetts Amherst
College of Information and Computer Science
@ sheldon@cs.umass.edu

Eric L. Garland

Professor in the Department of Psychiatry
University of California San Diego
Director of UCSD ONEMIND
@ egarland@health.ucsd.edu

Subhransu Maji

Associate Professor of Computer Science
University of Massachusetts Amherst
Co-Director of Computer Vision Lab
@ smaji@cs.umass.edu